

“*Dawson’s Creek* as it Represents My Generation”

My generation is one of uniqueness. My generation is one of high hopes and aspirations. My generation will make history. I believe that my generation is something special, a group of young adults that face situations and events different than any other. The teens right now have unique situations and problems. War is not an issue, living in poverty is minimal, and the biggest strife comes from ones social life. Problems arise from the constantly changing groups of friends, almost disposable boyfriends and girlfriends, and stress from outside influences such as school, work, and parents. My generation is immensely different from every one before and after.

The identity of the young adults of my generation, and the trials and tribulations they go through is shown quite accurately in the television show *Dawson’s Creek*. This program focuses on a group of six close friends. The main and title character is Dawson Leary, who identifies with the teen audience very well. Dawson is a fifteen year old male, who faces many complex situations and has to deal with them. This is much like a teen males life in my generation. For instance, Dawson deals with the divorce of his parents, a traumatic, but very real experience for watchers of the show. The show handles the situation much like a real world divorce would work, with separate custody. Dawson has to visit each parent, and deal with the loss of a pair of strong parents. Not every young adult of my generation has to deal with this, but divorce rates being 50% currently, its a very real event and the show represents it well.

Another family situation that *Dawson's Creek* represents is a no-parent family. The character of Joey Potter, has a father in jail, a mother that died, and the only somewhat-parental influence she has is an older sister, that is a single mother. This TV family manages to cover a lot of bases in the real world. My generation sees many single mothers, as well as some parentless families. Additionally, the show echos the poverty that some families are forced to deal with because situations make it hard to provide.

The characters of Jack and Andie MacPhee are brother and sister and represent a portion of my generation that is not too often seen. The MacPhee family has a mother in an insane asylum, and a commanding and often absent father. Additionally, Andie is a manic depressive and has undergone therapy. This is representative of my generation, for many teenagers face chemical imbalances and flash-depression due to bad social experiences and lack of parental figures. The character of Jack MacPhee is teen-aged and gay. He represents the section of society that is gay, teen, and willing to admit it. Jack shows perseverance and offers the gay teen viewers hope that the problems they face by being open will fade and they can live life as well as any other person of their generation.

Jen Linly is an outcast of her generation, formerly living in New York, she saw trouble in the form of too much sexuality. Her parents shipped her to the country and the neighborhood of Dawson Leary to calm down and have a respectable high-school experience. The character of Jen is representative of the drug-happy portion of my generation, and their hope of getting out of that malicious lifestyle.

The character of Pacey Whitter is representative of the portion of society that has an abusive father and is constantly trying to rebel. Pacey goes through numerous confrontations with the law and school-board just trying to get a fair deal. Justice is never received it would

seem, which is exactly how a portion of the shows audience feels.

The interaction of the characters on *Dawson's Creek* is also representative of my generation. The characters of Pacey and Dawson have recently had fights over Joey, who loves them both. Joey, unable to make a choice is stuck in the middle of two former best-friends fighting over her. This is seen in real life as well as the show, as my generation has constant battles over girls as well as friends quickly turning to enemies. Other interactions the program shows are school interactions, such as the prom, classes with abusively-hard teachers, and confrontations between different "cliques."

The uniqueness of my generation is mirrored in *Dawson's Creek*. The show was not written for merely entertainment, but to relate with the audience and possibly to help them. It is the correlation between the characters and real life people that viewers know that makes the program interesting. Serving as another group of friends, the show allows viewers to slip into their world for the hour of each show. Unknowingly for the most part, the world of *Dawson's Creek* and the world of the viewers are one in the same. If the watcher actually takes a good look around, they would see that the show accurately represents my generation.